

HKUWW Premier Exchange Primer

A source-backed brief for Shen Ruililin on how to spend one HKU Worldwide slot in 2027/28 — Chicago, Columbia, LSE, Tokyo, Kyoto, Waseda, and the Tung & Ngai Mainland mandate — without inventing fees or twinning prestige hunger.

Two stacks are equals. No default winner. Quotas are from the last full published list (9 Oct 2025). The 2027/28 partner PDF is not out yet. Confirm T&N Mainland duration in writing before betting a Chicago year on LINK or a summer school. Confirm GHAD3001 with SPH before betting a full year against the China CDC window.

For: Shen Ruililin · BAsC Global Health and Development · HKU

Compiled 19 August 2026 · Operator plane · Not Pages

Apply 12 Oct–11 Dec 2026 for AY 2027/28

Research: IAO/host/T&N pages · Sol · Fable · Opus · regional crawls

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0. How to read this

You already pay **HKU local tuition**, and Tung & Ngai covers it. That is the whole arbitrage. A year at Chicago billed as a Chicago student is in the high five figures of US dollars. A year at Chicago billed as an HKU exchange student is HKU composition fee — which T&N pays. The “steal” is real. It is also **not unique to Chicago**, not free of living costs, and not the same thing as a public-health degree.

What you asked for (Chicago, Columbia, LSE, Todai, Waseda, Kyoto, AFPLA at PKU/Fudan) is treated as a **named set**, not as the only schools that exist. Peer cards exist so prestige-myopia does not eat the preference list.

Subagents used (2026-08-19): Sol (GPT-5.6) on value/calendar; Fable (Claude Fable 5) on experience/access; Opus 5 on an adversarial GHD-tool review (companion: `docs/exchange-review-ghd-hkuww.md`); regional crawls for Japan, Mainland, and Anglosphere. This document is the synthesis, not a paste of those chats. Where Opus treated the **March leftover PDF** as the full catalogue, that error is discarded here and flagged in the companion’s editor’s note.

How numbers are labelled

- **Published / dated:** copied from an official page with an access date.
- **Arithmetic:** FX conversion of a published figure. Rounded to the nearest HK\$1,000 unless the source is already round.
- **UNVERIFIED:** not on an official page we fetched, or the official page is silent.
- **Proxy:** 2026/27 quota used as *shape* for 2027/28. The 27/28 partner PDF is not out.

1. Corrections (do not twin)

1. **Chicago is not the only full-year elite on HKUWW.** The 9 Oct 2025 list's full-year column includes Chicago (4), LSE (5), Durham (5), UTokyo (3), Kyoto (1), Waseda (2), Osaka (5), Sophia (2), Tohoku (1), Akita (3). LSE and the Japanese national universities are full-year **by HKUWW rule**, not by accident.
2. **Columbia is semester-only** (6 spots). IAO duration: Fall/Spring. Do not write it as a year.
3. **BASc pages that name Oxford / Cambridge / Yale are not HKUWW exchange.** Worldwide Plus Visiting currently lists **Oxford only** (St Peter's / Pembroke). Cambridge is not a Worldwide Plus partner on the live IAO page. **Yale Y-VISP is officially closed.** 2026/27 St Peter's course fees £41,390–£54,380 plus £8,806 accommodation. HKU visiting scholarship is up to HK\$100,000. That is a different product. HSBC Global Scholarship is the cash that might make it rational; T&N's HK\$80k exchange cap will not.
4. **AFPL in your usage is AFPLA** — Asian Future Political Leaders Association. Five universities: PKU, Fudan, UTokyo, SNU, NTU. Student club + annual summer forum. Not a dual degree, not an exchange programme, **not a guaranteed seat** for an HKU inbound.
5. **Spending HKUWW on PKU/Fudan and later spending HKUWW on Chicago is not allowed** under current IAO rules: previous IAO/faculty/department semester or visiting exchange disqualifies you. Faculty pages also say at most one offer across HKUWW / faculty / departmental.
6. **GHD is not MBBS, but PKU still blocks the Health Science Center** for standard exchange. "Medicine programmes or courses are not available" on the Oct 2025 list. Partner fact sheets: Health Science Center not available to ordinary exchange students. A Beida semester is a **university** semester, not a SPH semester, unless you find a faculty-specific channel.
7. **The March 2026 PDF is leftovers.** Chicago and Columbia vanish from it. UCEAP pool drops from 70 (Oct) to 18 S1 (March). Waseda and Kyoto also drop off the leftover sheet. An adversarial pass that treated the March PDF as the full catalogue concluded Chicago/Columbia/Waseda were *unavailable* — that is a **list-artefact error**, not a programme cancellation. The 9 Oct 2025 sheet is the last *complete* published 2026/27 catalogue: Chicago 4 FY, Columbia 6 S, Waseda 2 FY, Kyoto 1 FY. The 27/28 list is not published yet. Plan from Oct 2025 *shape*, never from leftover inventory.
8. **Exchange grades do not enter your HKU GPA.** BASc(GHD) regulations and the Senate credit-transfer policy: transferred credits appear, **host results are not in GPA**, and host grades typically do not appear on the HKU transcript. T&N renewal at 3.50 is therefore **not** threatened by a brutal Core. The real cost of a full year is the **opposite**: you convert ~60 credits from *graded HKU evidence* into ungraded transfer. For a 4.09 student, a year spends the asset rather than growing it. Outright **fails** that block credit transfer are a different risk (progress, not GPA).
9. **AFPL is two different objects.** **AFPLA** = student forum (PKU, Fudan, Todai, SNU, NTU). **AFLSP** = Bai Xian Asia Institute scholarship (partners include PKU, Tsinghua, SJTU, Kyoto, Waseda, CUHK, HKUST — **not HKU**). No HKUWW destination makes you an AFLSP scholar. Postgraduate at a BXAI partner is the real door.
10. **ISALs are not Core prisoners.** Chicago International Students-at-Large have full access to the College catalogue and **no academic requirements to UChicago**; the Core is a degree requirement, not an exchange obligation. You *may* take Core seminars. Competitive registration still applies. Harris is consultation-and-seat, not a promise.
11. **There is no elite undergraduate SPH year to buy.** Mailman is graduate. LSHTM is postgraduate-only. LSE's Department of Health Policy is **not** on the 2025/26 General Course open-department list. PKU SPH sits inside a blocked Health Science Center. The honest undergraduate public-health *course* path on this board is closer to **UBC SPPH 200/300-level** and Columbia CC's **Special Concentration in Public Health** bulletin courses than to "I will enrol at Mailman."
12. **NIID is gone.** On 1 April 2025 NIID and NCGM merged into **JIHS** (Japan Institute for Health Security). Japan-as-fieldwork and Japan-as-exchange are separate decisions. WHO WPRO is Manila, not Tokyo. WHO HQ is Geneva, not

2. The physics of one slot

IAO eligibility (2027/28 page, accessed 2026-08-19):

- Non-final year; cannot apply if you will be in the second-to-last or last semester.
- **Year 2+ priority** over Year 1. You will be Y2 in Oct 2026. This is the intended window.
- **Not joined any previous semester exchange or special visiting programme organised by IAO, faculties or departments.**
- CGPA 3.0+ “relatively higher chance.” Assessment uses **CGPA as of Semester 1 of the application year.**
- IELTS 6.5 or TOEFL 93 for IAO. Hosts are often higher (Chicago IELTS 7.0 all subs / TOEFL 104; Columbia IELTS 7.5 / TOEFL 105). IB English A 7 may satisfy *some* IAO uploads; hosts still often want a test. **Book IELTS/TOEFL so the report is valid through host deadlines (often Apr 2027 for FY).**
- Personal statement: **100 words.** Full-year applicants must justify full year because FY quota is scarce.
- Deposit HK\$2,000 on acceptance (12 Feb 2027 for main round).

What does *not* burn the slot (current published taxonomy — Horizons splits “Exchange/Visiting” from “Short-term Study/Study Trip”):

- China Vision short programmes (Mainland Affairs), typically 2–5 weeks.
- LINK (Teaching & Learning): 12-credit HKU course with a **3-week** Shanghai or HCMC immersion.
- GHD **capstone field placement** (separate SPH mechanism).
- Wu Zhi Qiao / service (already done).
- Recognized Programmes summer sessions (fee-paying; PKU SSI, Fudan ISS, UTokyo GUC, etc.).

What *does* burn the slot: HKUWW semester or year; faculty/department semester exchange; Worldwide Plus **visiting** (explicitly “special visiting programmes organised by IAO”).

Uncertainty you must close in writing: whether Tung & Ngai’s “compulsory Mainland exchange” can be satisfied by LINK, China Vision summer, T&N’s own 10-day Dandelion programme, or only by a semester. Foundation text says **flexibility on programme duration** and the 2025 annual report *promotes* Tsinghua camp and a 10-day Beijing service-learning option. That is not a written waiver. Ask AASO / Foundation liaison before you bet a year of Chicago on it.

A second uncertainty: the eligibility clause is broad (“special visiting programmes organised by IAO, faculties or departments”). LINK is Teaching & Learning, not IAO, and Horizons classes it as short-term. **Get IAO (goabroad@hku.hk) to confirm in writing before you enrol.** Being wrong costs the slot.

3. How HKUWW actually allocates

Timeline (IAO, 2027/28 — live page)

PHASE	DATES	WHAT HAPPENS
Main round	12 Oct 2026 open; 11 Dec 2026 deadline	Online application. You will be Y2.
Interviews	Late Dec 2026 / mid-Jan 2027	If applicable
Results	5 Feb 2027	
Accept	12 Feb 2027 + HK\$2,000	

PHASE	DATES	WHAT HAPPENS
Nomination / host app (FY & S1)	Feb–May 2027	Host letters May–Aug 2027
Late round	List 1 Mar 2027; apply 5–12 Mar; results 2 Apr; accept 9 Apr	Leftovers. Do not plan Chicago from this round.
2nd late round	S2 only: list 26 Apr; apply 30 Apr–7 May; results 21 May; accept 28 May	

What IAO actually scores

Published: CGPA (S1 of application year), 100-word PS, English, interview if any. The 100 words must cover why exchange, why first-choice institution, why first-choice country, and **if FY, why a year**. FY quota is the scarce column; a FY PS that could equally describe a semester is a wasted shot.

Credit transfer physics (Senate policy, not a vibe)

- A host **semester** of full-time study normally converts to **up to 30 HKU credits, maximum 36**.
- A host **year** normally converts to **up to 60, maximum 72**.
- Hard ceiling **120 transferred credits** across the degree.
- Approval **before departure**. Whole courses only for major mapping; rejects fall through to electives.
- Host grades **do not enter GPA** and typically **do not appear** on the HKU transcript.

Faculty of Social Sciences publishes a “50% of major at HKU, including capstone” rule. **That is FSS, not Medicine**. The HKUMed/SPH equivalent for BAsC(GHD) is **UNVERIFIED**. Obtain it in writing. GHD Year 3 is 66 credits with **48 elective** — structurally the year built to absorb a *semester*. A full year fights GHAD3001.

Faculty column

GHD is hosted by **SPH / LKS Medicine**. HKUWW faculty earmarks for you are likely **Medicine**. Many hosts mark Medicine N/A; that usually means **MBBS/clinical**, not “no GHD student may apply.” PKU’s line is harsher because it names programmes **or courses**. UBC Oct 2025: 30 spots with Medicine earmark **3** and no medicine-course block on the PDF line. McGill: Medicine programmes unavailable, yet Medicine seats exist. **Inference, not fact:** Medicine-earmarked seats may be a thinner queue because MBBS cohorts cannot easily leave. Verify with IAO.

4. Your calendar (operator-corrected)

WHEN	WHAT	CLASH WITH 2027/28 HKUWW?
Oct 2026	Laidlaw conference, London; GEST Valencia invited speaker	No. Does overlap application open (12 Oct) . Prep ranking, 100-word PS, transcript, and course map <i>before</i> you leave.
Winter 2026/27	LINK Shanghai (3-week immersion + HKU course)	No, if LINK is not classed as IAO/faculty semester exchange. Confirm. Interviews sit late Dec / mid-Jan — do not vanish.
Oct–Dec 2026	HKUWW 2027/28 application	This is the work.
Feb 2027	Results 5 Feb; accept by 12 Feb	
Summer 2027	Laidlaw LiA, Medellín / Mexico City	Compatible with a late-Sep Chicago autumn quarter. Tight if LSE Welcome is mid-Sep and LiA overruns. Same summer as China Vision PKU/Fudan — pick one geography.
2027/28	HKUWW year or semester	The slot.

WHEN	WHAT	CLASH WITH 2027/28 HKUWW?
Y3–Y4	GHD 6-month overseas capstone (12 credits). Aim: China CDC	Cannot be replaced by HKUWW. First GHD cohort's published <i>exchange</i> example is UBC , not Chicago. UBC is not the capstone host.

Load-bearing syllabus fact (BASc(GHD) regulations): GHAD4010 capstone is *normally* taken from **Year 3 Summer through end of Year 4 Semester 1**. Prerequisite includes GHAD3001 Global health policy — a **Year 3 course**. (SPH's public curriculum page has also been crawled as listing a Y4 GHAD4001 — treat the **code collision as UNVERIFIED** and use the regulations PDF until SPH writes.) Year 3 is 66 credits with **48 elective**. A **single semester** in Y3 fits the elective hole. A **full year in Y3** is the year you would miss GHAD3001, which can slide the capstone and collide with graduation. **Confirm with SPH whether GHAD3001 can be taken in Y2 or Y4, or remotely.** Until that is written, Stack A (Chicago/LSE/Todai FY) is purchased with the China CDC window — which is the degree-level aim in your T&N profile.

Also UNVERIFIED and load-bearing: whether a mainland China posting satisfies the capstone's "overseas field placement" language, and whether China CDC is an approvable host. If the answer is no, the whole China CDC plan needs a different vehicle — more urgent than ranking Chicago against LSE.

A **Y4 full year is probably illegal** under the "second-to-last / last semester" rule for a 4-year degree. Do not plan Chicago for 2028/29 unless SPH confirms a stretch.

Host calendars that matter if Stack A is FY 2027/28

HOST	PUBLISHED CALENDAR FRAGMENT	VS Y4
LSE	Welcome Week 17 Sep 2027 ; Spring Term ends 16 Jun 2028 (term-dates page)	Cleaner Y4 buffer than Japan
UTokyo Type U	Autumn admission Oct–Mar or Oct–Sep; fact sheet nomination 14 Feb / application 28 Feb	Transcript lag into Y4
Kyoto	Exams early Aug; semester formally ends 30 Sep	Tight vs HKU Y4 start
Chicago	2027/28 dates not on the public future-calendar crawl	UNVERIFIED; autumn quarter typically late Sep
Columbia	Host deadlines (2026 cycle as shape): Fall/AY 10 Apr ; Spring 1 Oct	Semester; you are home by Dec or May

5. Tung & Ngai money (published)

Source: tungngaifoundation.org/financial-awards-benefits (accessed 2026-08-19).

BENEFIT	DETAIL
Tuition	Full HKU tuition while you hold the scholarship
Living	HK\$40,000 / year
Exchange subsidy	Up to HK\$80,000 covering one compulsory Mainland + optional international , duration flexible
Endeavour	Up to HK\$100,000 for GBA/Mainland career or start-up — do not budget this for ordinary exchange living

Renewal: GPA ≥ 3.50 (AASO scheme text). Because host grades do not enter HKU GPA, a brutal Core **does not mechanically** push 4.09 below 3.50. Remaining risks: failing credits that do not transfer; delayed graduation; whatever T&N writes into the annual progress report (**UNVERIFIED** whether they read host transcripts separately).

HKU composition fee:

- **2025-26 local (your entry cohort handbook):** HK\$44,500.
- **2026-27 new-intake local:** HK\$47,000.

- **2026-27 non-local STEM (Medicine included):** HK\$249,000 — irrelevant if you remain a local composition-fee student; cited so you never mix the two columns.
- Some HKU fee schedules lock the admission-year rate for the normal duration; **do not assume 44,500 forever**. T&N covers whatever HKU bills. 2027/28 local fee is **unpublished here**; wedges below use 44,500 and note sensitivity.

The HK\$80k is a **shared cap**, not two pots of 80k. A Chicago year that costs HK\$220k–275k out of pocket in housing and insurance will not be “fully funded” by T&N. The steal is **tuition**, not Cost of Attendance.

Whether the HK\$40k living allowance remains fully usable while you are abroad is UNVERIFIED. If it does, exchange-year T&N cash is 40k + (up to) 80k = 120k, still short of Chicago/LSE living.

6. FX used for wedges (dated, approximate)

Market prints around 18–19 Aug 2026 (not a bank quote you should wire against). Sol also derived from ECB eurofxref the same day: USD/HKD **7.8416**, GBP/HKD **10.6301**, JPY/HKD **0.049292**, CNY/HKD **1.16375**. Primer arithmetic below uses the rounder market set:

- USD/HKD $\approx$ **7.8439**
- GBP/HKD $\approx$ **10.63**
- JPY/HKD $\approx$ **0.0493**
- CNY/HKD $\approx$ **1.16**

Round wedges to the nearest HK\$1,000. Re-convert before you sign anything.

Tuition wedge = host *degree-seeking* undergraduate sticker (what you do not pay on exchange) – HKU local composition fee (what T&N pays).

OOP = housing + mandatory host fees + insurance you actually pay. Not sticker tuition. Wedge is **counterfactual access value, not a cash refund**.

7. Two equal stacks

You asked for both, with no default.

Stack A — spend HKUWW on a premier overseas year

- **HKUWW 2027/28:** Chicago (FY) or LSE (FY) as first preference; Japan FY as structured alternatives.
- **T&N Mainland:** non-HKUWW path — LINK winter 2026/27 (already planned), and/or China Vision PKU/Fudan summer, and/or T&N-promoted short Mainland programmes. **Get the Foundation to say yes in writing.**
- **AFPLA:** not automatic. Possible only if you later sit a summer forum as a guest, or if a Japan/Todai year lets you recruit into the UTokyo chapter (unverified for exchange students).
- **GHD capstone:** Y4, China CDC still the aim — **if SPH moves GHAD3001**.
- **T&N story:** global methods year, then return to China/HK institutions. Matches mobility-with-intention only if the return clause is real.

Stack B — spend HKUWW on PKU or Fudan

- **HKUWW:** PKU (20 semester spots Oct 2025; medicine/HSC blocked) or Fudan (10). Tsinghua is 2 spots — lottery, not a plan.
- **No second HKUWW year.** Columbia/Chicago/LSE/Todai via IAO are gone.

- **AFPLA:** physically on a member campus (PKU or Fudan). Membership still requires that chapter's CV + interview. Unverified for inbound exchange.
- **T&N story:** almost frictionless. Compulsory Mainland is the semester. Optional international then has to be a **non-IAO** path (Laidlaw LiA already is; summer schools; GHD capstone).
- **Mandarin:** your actual edge. Chinese-taught social science / public policy / international studies at PKU/Fudan is usable in a way it is not for most HKUWW outbound.
- **Channel check:** IAO-hosted PKU Spring 2026 fact sheet is **港澳台交换流程**. PKU ISD's GVS1 page is written for students of **non-Chinese nationality**. Those can be different doors. Confirm with IAO which door HKUWW nominees walk through. Do not assume the English ISD page is your form.

Decision matrix (equals)

AXIS	STACK A (CHICAGO/LSE YEAR)	STACK B (PKU/FUDAN SEMESTER)
Duration (you prefer longer)	9–10 months	4–5 months unless a Mainland host offers FY (PKU IAO page is Fall/Spring; confirm FY)
Tuition wedge	Very large (Chicago ~HK\$0.5M; LSE ~HK\$0.26–0.38M)	Small / negative (Mainland public UG tuition is not Chicago)
OOP living	High (Chicago/London). T&N 80k does not cover.	Lower. 80k likely covers a large share.
T&N 3.50	Not at risk from host grades (GPA-exempt). Cost is thinner graded HKU record + GHAD3001/capstone collision	Same GPA-exempt; shorter so less thinning
Public-health courses	Chicago College catalogue + Harris <i>if</i> they let you in; LSE health/social policy units exist but Health Policy dept is closed to GC; not Mailman, not LSHTM enrolment	PKU SPH / HSC blocked on standard HKUWW; Fudan medical UG blocked. You buy the city and the university , not the medical school
T&N China narrative	Needs a documented non-HKUWW Mainland	Native
AFPLA	Only if Todai year + chapter admits you; or summer forum as outsider	On PKU/Fudan campus; still a club admissions process
China CDC / CHP	Methods year abroad, then Y4 placement — if the prerequisite chain survives	Institutional fluency in Beijing/Shanghai, then Y4 placement
English test	Chicago 7.0 / Columbia 7.5 / LSE standard	Host-dependent; HK students often use Chinese tracks
Laidlaw London 2026	Preview of a city you might inhabit 2027/28 (LSE)	Unrelated
Cap remainder after living	Chicago/LSE: negative (gap HK\$70k–130k+ even if 40k living is usable abroad)	PKU/Fudan: often positive remainder inside the 80k

Pick A if you believe the scarce good is **a full year inside a hyper-selective English-language undergraduate college at local HKU fees**, and you can satisfy T&N without burning the slot, **and SPH writes that GHAD3001 can move**.

Pick B if you believe the scarce good is **a semester inside Beida/Fudan as a Mandarin-capable GHD/T&N scholar**, AFPLA adjacency, Y3 elective-fit, and you can live without a Chicago/LSE year because the GHD capstone plus LiA already give you “abroad.”

Neither is a moral failure. Optimising for prestige appearance over optionality rate *is*.

Do not blend preference lists. A form that ranks Chicago then PKU then LSE is a different thesis on every line. IAO will not save you from that.

8. Named set — deep dives

8.1 University of Chicago (EXTU10960)

IAO: full year; English; pay HKU tuition. Programme page.

Oct 2025 quota: 4 full-year spots, *******, no faculty earmarks listed. Restriction: **Full year only**.

Host status: International Students-at-Large (ISALs). J-1. Coming to UChicago.

Fact sheet 2025-26 (HKU-hosted PDF): ISALs have **full access to the College course catalogue** and “courses in select graduate programs and professional schools.” **No academic requirements to UChicago**. Minimum 3 / maximum 4 courses per quarter (300–400 units) → **9–12 courses/year**. **Course registration is competitive; enrolment in the student’s major is not guaranteed**. Off-campus Hyde Park — **no on-campus guarantee**. English: TOEFL 104 (26 each) or IELTS 7 (7 each) or Duolingo 135.

Core is optional. The Core is a College *degree* requirement. ISALs may take Core seminars; they are not sentenced to them. Partner guidance (Edinburgh) still warns that UChicago is a poor fit for students who need guaranteed Public Policy / Statistics seats and that economics past intro typically wants **a full year of calculus**. Treat upper-level econ and Harris as **competitive, not guaranteed**. Harris appears on some partner handouts as a professional school “upon consultation.” Harris also publishes its own undergraduate-exchange bursar line — do not confuse that product with College ISAL.

There is no undergraduate SPH major. Routes: Health and Society minor; Biological Sciences interdisciplinary focus in Global and Public Health; Public Policy (PBPL) with a health-policy area. Department of Public Health Sciences (PBHS) is graduate-level.

Why the steal is real

ITEM	FIGURE	SOURCE
College tuition 2025-26	USD 71,325	UChicago historical COA / bursar College 2025-26
In HKD (USD 7.8439)	≈ HK\$559,000	FX 18 Aug 2026
HKU local you (T&N) pay	HK\$44,500 (2025-26 handbook)	HKU UG handbook
Tuition wedge	≈ HK\$515,000 for the year	Arithmetic
Housing & food 2025-26 (degree COA)	USD 20,835	same COA page
Student services + U-Pass	USD 1,623 + 318	same
USHIP (2024-25 published)	USD 1,666 / quarter; ≈ 4,998 / year; waivable with comparable cover	COA footnote + ISAL page
Fact sheet billed items (2024-25 AY, per quarter)	Tuition 22,482 (waived on exchange) + services 520 + U-Pass 106 + insurance 1,666	HKU-hosted fact sheet

OOP ballpark for an ISAL year (you pay): housing/food in Hyde Park (use USD 20k–25k unless you find cheaper; Sol’s bursar-line housing/food USD 17,502 is a **lower bound** if you beat the COA housing line), services+U-Pass ~USD 2k, insurance unless waived ~USD 5k, books/personal ~USD 4k. ≈ **USD 28k–35k** → **HK\$220,000–275,000**. A tighter bursar-only stack lands nearer **HK\$193,000**. T&N living HK\$40k + a slice of HK\$80k covers a minority. Family capital / other awards fill the rest. Do not tell yourself the year is “free.”

Rigor help / hurt

- Help: letters from a College that still grades mean; Harris *if* you actually get in; Core-style writing *if you choose it*; winter quarter long enough to do something other than tourism; methods + political economy for the seam thesis.
- Hurt: **not T&N 3.50** (exchange is GPA-exempt). Competitive registration. Off-campus housing search from Hong Kong. Quarter calendar. **Harris School is not the College**. The academic cost is a thinner *graded* HKU transcript and

the **GHAD3001 / capstone collision** if the year is Y3.

City: Chicago is a serious American city for urban health, hospitals, and winter. It is not UN Plaza and it is not LSE's Whitehall-adjacent density. Midwestern hub flights to both coasts exist; they cost time.

Fit for you: Best **tuition-arbitrage full year in English** on the list. Best if you want undergraduate intellectual intensity more than a SPH building. Worst if you need guaranteed epi lab seats.

Preference-list role (Stack A): #1 if the 100-word PS can honestly say: full year because the College is a three-quarter curriculum and a semester is a mutilation; public health here means methods + political economy, not clinical rotations.

Fact-sheet checklist (Chicago): ISAL vs Harris product; 2027/28 quarter dates; USHIP waiver rules; off-campus housing timeline; whether PBPL/Harris seats are realistic without calc; J-1 proof of funds.

8.2 Columbia University (EXTU10662)

IAO: Fall/Spring (semester). Programme page.

Oct 2025: 6 semester spots, *.**

Host: Incoming exchange via Undergraduate Global Engagement; **CC/SEAS courses. Not GS.** Incoming exchange. English bar: **TOEFL 105 / IELTS 7.5 / Duolingo 135**. Exemption *may* exist for long English-medium instruction — **verify**; HKU is English-medium, secondary schooling may or may not count. You pay tuition to HKU. At Columbia you pay room/board, student activity fees, medical insurance, travel, books. Housing “strongly encouraged”; **placement not guaranteed until arrival**.

2026-27 degree COA (for scale, not your bill): tuition USD 72,800; continuing on-campus total budget USD 100,884 (CC-SEAS facts).

2025-26 incoming-exchange fee table (host page): Student Life ~USD 917/term; International Services ~USD 170/term; room & board ~USD 18,680/AY; Health fee ~USD 723/term; medical insurance ~USD 2,044 Fall / 3,323 Spring; document fee ~USD 105. **Semester OOP easily USD 12k–16k (HK\$95k–125k) before flights.** Sol's itemised stack: **HK\$104k fall / HK\$114k spring.**

Tuition wedge (one semester): ~USD 36,400 × 7.8439 ≈ HK\$286,000 minus ~HK\$22,250 ≈ **HK\$264,000**. Large, but **half a Chicago year**, and you are done in December or May. Same one-slot token.

Rigor / access: Mailman SPH and SIPA are graduate schools. Incoming UG exchange is CC/SEAS. Host page: generally **cannot take professional or graduate school courses**. The workable public-health path is the **CC Special Concentration in Public Health** — Mailman-taught courses that live on the **CC bulletin** (examples crawled: PUBH UN3100, UN3200, HSPB UN2950; some GU4100 / GU4200 open to undergrads). That is not a Mailman degree. Load: typically 5 courses (15–18 points), minimum 12. NYC *as a city* is the public-health density (UN, NYC DOHMH, NGOs). That is fieldwork adjacency, not a transcript line.

Duration vs your preference: You said longer is better. Columbia loses that contest to Chicago, LSE, and Todai **by construction**.

Fit: Stack A **backup semester** if FY Chicago/LSE miss — but a semester still burns the one slot. Do not put Columbia #1 if you mean a year. Do not put it on a blended list “just in case” unless you accept four months in NYC as the whole instrument.

8.3 LSE (EXTU11459)

IAO: full year; English; HKU tuition.

Oct 2025: 5 FY spots, *, ≥2 years of study**, full year only.

March leftover PDF: 3 spots — meaning FY LSE fills in the main round.

Host: GO LSE reciprocal exchange, **not** the fee-paying General Course. HKU country page. LSE requires **CGPA 3.3/4.3** (qualitative) and **3.5** for quantitative/econ tracks; two years of university by arrival. No single-semester study abroad. Four

full-unit year-long UG courses (or equivalent half-units). Transcript issued **at year end** (May/June exams). 300-level units described as “exceptionally demanding.” Some courses capped FCFS; some closed to visiting students.

Housing: GO LSE students who book by the published deadline are **guaranteed** LSE/UL halls subject to availability (2026-27 offer pack; that year’s book-by date was **9 Jun 2026** — use the 2027/28 pack when issued). Deposit £250 in that pack.

Overseas sticker you do not pay (2026/27 Table of Fees): programme-dependent. International Relations £30,700; International Social and Public Policy £28,900; Economics £39,900. General Course page has also published **£29,600** as a visiting sticker — GO LSE students still **do not pay** it; use it only as a wedge comparator.

Wedge vs HK\$44,500:

- ISPP/Politics band £28,900 × 10.63 ≈ HK\$307,000 – 44,500 ≈ **HK\$263,000**
- IR £30,700 → wedge ≈ **HK\$282,000**
- Economics £39,900 → wedge ≈ **HK\$379,000**

OOP (GO LSE Offer Pack 2026-27): 39-week living guide **£19,030** (accommodation from £11,450 + food £4,095 + other £3,485) ≈ **HK\$202,000**. IHS **£776** for Student visa / NHS. Private insurance optional.

Fit for GHD: Closest **English-language social-science / development** year on HKUWW. You will not get a wet lab. GO LSE students are told to read **General Course** course lists. The 2025/26 General Course department list **does not include the Department of Health Policy** (nor International Development as a department). Social Policy is open; crawled module names in that department are education, poverty, ethnicity, urbanisation, NGOs, migration — **not** a health-economics year. Sociology’s S0232 Sociology of Health and Illness is the nearest labelled health unit in the GC crawl. LSE Global Health Initiative modules that *sound* like your degree (Key Issues in Global Health and Development, epidemic response) sit in departments **not** on the GC list.

Treat LSE as **development / public policy / econometrics**, plus a city that contains LSHTM (~15 minutes’ walk), UKHSA, Wellcome, Chatham House. City adjacency ≠ enrolment. WHO HQ is Geneva.

Rigor: Year-end assessment is a feature. Host grades do not enter HKU GPA. The cost is GHAD3001 / capstone timing, not T&N 3.50.

vs Chicago: Smaller tuition wedge than Chicago; better policy/development catalogue alignment *if* you want Social Policy / econ rather than College mythos; guaranteed halls if you hit the deadline; full-year lock-in identical in spirit. Chicago wins on “only US FY” scarcity. LSE wins on *your subject as actually taught to visiting students* — development methods, not Health Policy department.

Fact-sheet checklist (LSE): 2027/28 GO LSE offer pack; GC open-department list that year; whether any Health Policy exception exists; hall book-by date; IHS; Welcome Week vs LiA end date.

8.4 University of Tokyo (EXTU10925)

Oct 2025: 3 FY, *, CGPA 3.3, ≥2 years, full year only.**

March leftover: 2.

IAO: full year. Host English path: **USTEP Type U** (and GLA English). Host Type U page also allows **one semester** — tension with HKUWW “full year only.” After an offer, confirm with IAO whether a semester is even placeable.

Type U registers students in the **Senior Division** (third- and fourth-year), which is why two completed years are required. **Over 300 English-taught courses/year** (humanities, social sciences, STEM), via the Type U catalogue — not the general UG search. **Labs/practicals closed.** Regular Japanese-taught faculties need **JLPT N1**. English bar: TOEFL 90 / IELTS 6.5 / C1 / DET 120, **or exemption if undergraduate instruction is in English** (HKU likely qualifies — get a certification letter). Min **6 class periods**.

Tuition for degree-seeking UG (2025+ entrants) **¥642,960/year** (UTokyo tuition) $\approx$ **HK\$32,000**. **Tuition wedge vs HKU is near zero or negative**. The steal is not money. The steal is Today + Tokyo + (maybe) AFPLA.

Visa proof commonly **¥120,000/month** (full year **¥1,440,000** $\approx$ HK\$71,000). Housing: “most students successfully accommodated” but **not guaranteed**. Ten months at ¥120,000 = ¥1.2M $\approx$ HK\$59,000 — cheaper than Chicago housing *if* that budget is real. National Health Insurance is mandatory; yen amount **unpublished** in the crawl.

English: Public-health-adjacent access is **catalogue luck**, not a SPH enrolment. GLA English includes SDG themes (health among them). Do not assume a thick epi offering.

AFPLA: Only UTokyo among the Japan named set has a documented chapter (afpla-ut.com). Recruiting: information session, CV, interview, spring cycle, then study groups into a summer forum. **Whether inbound exchange students can sit the interview is not published**. A full-year Oct start *can* hit spring recruiting in the second semester; a fall-only semester misses both recruiting and the summer forum. Treat as a hypothesis to test with the chapter — too late to be the *reason* you chose Today, useful as upside.

JHHS: Japan’s CDC-analogue after the 1 Apr 2025 merger. Agency, not a university. No undergraduate exchange runs through it. Useful as a *thesis comparator* (another East Asian state rebuilding health-security architecture), not as a course code.

Nomination (Type U fact sheet): Autumn: nomination **14 Feb**; application **28 Feb**; results early May. That is a tight pipe after HKUWW accept on 12 Feb 2027.

8.5 Kyoto University (EXTU10362)

1 FY spot, *******, CGPA 3.3, **full year only**. English path: **KUINEP** (ILAS). Degree UG tuition **¥535,800** $\approx$ HK\$26,000. Host also describes one-semester stays; HKUWW still FY-only.

KUINEP: all courses in English; ≥ 7 **courses/semester**, mostly ILAS liberal arts, **designed mainly for 1st/2nd years** on partner fact sheets. Faculty courses only with lecturer permission. **Medicine closed**. TOEFL 79 / IELTS 6.5 (Kyoto pages; some sheets cite TOEFL 72). General Exchange (GE) is the Japanese-medium faculty track — N1 territory.

Fit for Y3 GHD: Weak on policy/PH. One spot is not a plan; it is a lottery ticket behind Today/Osaka. City: unmatched as a place to live; thin as a GHD English catalogue. Kyoto *is* a BXAI/AFLSP partner — that still does not confer AFLSP on an HKU undergraduate.

8.6 Waseda (EXTU11506)

2 FY, ****** (not *******), CGPA 3.3, **full year only**. Host fact sheet also allows one semester; HKUWW FY-only. Private. School-placement model (CIE). Apply to **one school**; take courses primarily there; degree-student seminars closed; lottery if oversubscribed; **~6 courses/week** recommended.

SILS is a separate English-medium school — easier English access than Today/Kyoto *if* you are placed there. Political Science and Economics also runs an English program. Confirm school lists in the year’s Application Guidelines. Tuition wedge larger than national universities because Waseda sticker is private (faculty-dependent 2026 disclosure: Social Sciences $\sim$ ¥1,251,000; SILS $\sim$ ¥1,690,000 — **do not quote a single Waseda total** without the school table). Sol’s implied wedge vs HKU is only tens of thousands HKD, not a Chicago steal.

COE proof: **¥120,000/month**. Fact sheet living colour: Shinjuku $\sim$ ¥80,000 housing + ¥80,000 living/month. **JASSO scholarships not available for AY 2026 at Waseda** (fact sheet). Dorms “extremely popular”; commercial housing often 40–60 minutes out.

No AFPLA chapter in the crawl. Waseda is a BXAI partner — again, not your undergraduate door.

8.7 Osaka (EXTU10241)

5 FY, *******, CGPA 3.3, ≥2 years, **FY only** on the Oct 2025 PDF. IAO HTML duration has been crawled as Fall/Spring — **prefer the PDF for placement length**, then confirm. English: **OUSSEP / FrontierLab**; Japanese tracks iExPO (N1/N2) and Maple. “All incoming exchange students **MUST** be enrolled in one of these programs.” Fact sheet: GPA 3.0/4.0 last year; **enrolment restrictions may apply to some medicine/dentistry-related schools**. Schools listed include Medicine, Allied Health, OSIPP.

Degree UG tuition **¥535,800**. College insurance ~¥12,000/semester or ¥16,000/year; NHI ¥2,000–3,000/month; housing examples Global Village ~¥60,000/month. More spots than Todai. Less of the name you care about. Useful as a **FY Japan insurance preference** under Todai.

9. Mainland chapter (Stack B and T&N)

Oct 2025 semester spots (all ******* unless noted):

HOST	SPOTS	MEDICINE EARMARK (PDF)	RESTRICTION THAT HITS YOU
Peking	20	3	Medicine programmes/courses not available. HSC/SPH standard exchange blocked.
Fudan	10	1	PDF: none. Fact sheets: UG basic medical / clinical / nursing not available; medical courses restricted; 医学院交换生仅限选课，不可参加实习。
Zhejiang	20	3	None in PDF
Nanjing	20	3	None in PDF
SJTU	10	1	None in PDF
Tsinghua	2	—	Tiny. Do not build identity on it. Vanke SPH is grad-only on partner sheets. Undergrad exchange grading crawled as Distinction/Pass/Fail — weak grad-school signal.
Renmin	10 (*)	1	Easier competitiveness

PKU as a GHD play: You get Weiming, general departments, Chinese- and some English-taught UG. You do **not** get BJMU/HSC by default. Min 4 courses/semester on the 港澳台 fact sheet; application in Simplified Chinese. Faculty-specific HKUMed–PKU channels exist in the news (MoU Dec 2024) — those are **not** HKUWW. If the point is China CDC adjacency, a **Y4 capstone** at CDC beats a Y3 Beida semester in a non-health faculty. If the point is Mandarin institutional fluency + AFPLA + T&N optics, Beida still works.

Fudan: Shanghai, which you already touch via LINK. A Fudan semester *plus* LINK is a lot of Shanghai and little geographic diversity. AFPLA member. English-taught list exists (OGP). Tracks: Chinese Language / General Advanced (UG) / Senior Advanced (EMA grad) — **cannot combine** EMA with UG exchange. HSK 5 often required for Chinese-taught tracks for non-native speakers; HK local / native Mandarin status may change that — **verify on the year’s fact sheet**. SPH access **UNVERIFIED** — email `incoming@fudan.edu.cn` before ranking Fudan above PKU *for coursework*. T&N Future Doctor Leadership Camp (Fudan + HKU Med) is a **separate** quota programme, not HKUWW.

Channel vs ISD English pages. International-exchange pages at PKU/Tsinghua describe nationality gates (GVS1: non-Chinese nationality; Tsinghua sheets exclude some PRC/hukou categories). HKUWW may use the 港澳台 partner track instead. This is a one-email question to IAO, not a self-diagnosis of identity.

China Vision summers (do not burn HKUWW):

PROGRAMME	2026 WINDOW (SHAPE, NOT 2027 PROMISE)	CREDIT?
PKU 港澳台 summer school	6 Jul–9 Aug	Faculty-dependent

PROGRAMME	2026 WINDOW (SHAPE, NOT 2027 PROMISE)	CREDIT?
Fudan International Summer Session	13 Jul–7 Aug	Faculty-dependent; some tuition waivers
PKU Summer School International	5–31 Jul	Faculty-dependent
SJTU Global Summer School	13 Jul–2 Aug	Faculty-dependent
Tsinghua–HKU–BMICPD camp	21–25 Aug	Certificate only

These are Mainland Affairs, Horizons “short-term.” T&N satisfaction: **uncertain**. Same summer as LiA 2027 — geography collision.

LINK: 12 HKU credits, **3 weeks** Shanghai or HCMC, HK\$5,000 subsidy. You already planned winter 2026/27. Strong “Mainland exposure,” weak “exchange” if a pedant is scoring duration. Official name is **LINK**, not a separate “LINK-S” product.

Non-means-tested Mainland Experience Scheme: once per UG, ≥3 days, faculty-organised; example reimbursement in China Vision materials (95 days → max HK\$8,400). EDB SSEBR **excludes Mainland**.

T&N 2025 annual report promotes short Mainland options for scholars (Tsinghua camp, 10-day Dandelion Beijing, Future Doctor Leadership Camp). That is the best published evidence that semester-length is **not** required. Still get the email.

10. AFPLA and AFLSP without romance

AFPLA (Asian Future Political Leaders Association): student club + summer forum since 2007. PKU, Fudan, UTokyo, SNU, NTU. Fudan joined 2008; UTokyo 2011; NTU 2014. UTokyo chapter is a registered student group; members split into Diplomacy, Politics, Economics, Society, History divisions; spring recruiting → summer forum in a rotating city (2025 Tokyo). Not a T&N substitute. Not automatic for inbound exchange. UT-BASE (student club database, **subjective**) has been read as implying open recruiting — **do not treat that as chapter law**. Email the chapter.

AFLSP (Asian Future Leaders Scholarship Program, Bai Xian / BXAI): up to ~US\$25k/year, summer programme, **partner universities do not include HKU** (Hong Kong partners: CUHK, HKUST). Network: Hitotsubashi ICS, Kyoto, PKU, SJTU, CUHK, HKUST, Tsinghua, Waseda. The **AFLSP Exchange Scholarship** awards **Japanese students** going to BXAI partners in Beijing/Shanghai/Hong Kong (up to US\$12,500) — the wrong direction for you. Choosing PKU to sit near Bai Xian scholars is proximity without membership. The real AFLSP door is a **master’s** at PKU/Tsinghua/SJTU/Kyoto/Waseda. **UNVERIFIED**: whether BXAI counts Hong Kong as a distinct region for the “away from home country or region” test.

If you said “AFPL” meaning the student forum, Stack B PKU/Fudan or Stack A Todai are the only HKUWW geometries that could even *introduce* you. If you meant Bai Xian, **no undergraduate HKUWW choice confers it**.

11. Peer board (so you do not forget they exist)

Use these as preference-list depth, not as a second thesis. Oct 2025 quotas unless marked leftover.

HOST	OCT 2025	WHY IT IS ON A GHD/T&N BOARD	WHY IT IS NOT #1
UCEAP (UC)	70 semester (Oct); leftover Mar 18 S1 + UCSC 4	Berkeley/UCLA/UCSD public health adjacent <i>if</i> campus lottery lands. Must research ≥3 campuses; first choice not guaranteed .	You do not pick the campus. Housing not guaranteed. FY OOP can eat the whole T&N cap.

HOST	OCT 2025	WHY IT IS ON A GHD/T&N BOARD	WHY IT IS NOT #1
Northwestern	4, S2 only	Serious US social science. 2026-27 visiting: housing USD 4,200/qtr + meals 2,950 + NU-SHIP 2,000 mandatory ≈ USD 12,500/qtr excl. tuition.	Spring-only; burns slot for a short stay
UNC Chapel Hill	8	Gillings BSPH exists on campus. Exchange access UNVERIFIED — one email.	Semester; not your named set
McGill	30	English, serious, large quota. Incoming: IHI ~CAD 350–404/term.	Professional schools blocked (Med, Nursing, Mgmt not via HKUWW); GHD first cohort did UBC not McGill
UBC	30 (Oct) / 15 leftover; Medicine earmark 3	Published GHD first-cohort destination. SPPH undergrad courses exist (SPPH 200/301 open to all; 300 Working in Global Health ; 303 environmental health; 304 Canadian health policy; 406 ageing) — limited seats; SPHA closed to exchange. Incoming: iMED CAD 338/term; MSP ~CAD 75/mo; U-Pass CAD 187.60/term. Housing lottery.	Not Chicago; not T&N-China; housing lottery
Toronto	16	St George. UHIP CAD 66/mo; housing CAD 1,200–2,700/mo.	Housing not guaranteed; CS/Rotman limited; Dalla Lana access unstated
Sciences Po	24, ≥2 years, **	Political institutions; 7 bachelor campuses. Campus by language/capacity.	Not health; French/English; **
UCL	6	London	Five departments only (Anthro, Arts&Sci, Econ, Geog, History of Art). Population Health Sciences not on the list . Med N/A. Leftover PDF: 1 S1. Fragile.
KCL	36	London; Medicine column not N/A on the Oct line; Education N/A. Leftover: 5 S1.	HKUWW restrictions still apply; health-faculty access UNVERIFIED
Edinburgh	24		Med N/A
Durham	5 FY	Another English FY	Not LSE
SNU	4	AFPLA member	Semester; Korean
NTU Taipei	10, CGPA 3.3	AFPLA member. College of Public Health restriction table crawled as “ no specific restrictions. ” Mandarin-medium.	Semester; not your named set; still not AFLSP
Melbourne	20		Semester; far; Med/Dent N/A; GHD example is UBC
Keio	6 S, **, CGPA 3.3, S2 only , Med/PE/business blocked	KIP English East Asia courses. Private sticker much higher than national unis.	Semester 2 only; not AFPLA

Worldwide Plus Oxford visiting: CGPA 3.7; pay Oxford. Scholarship HK\$100k. St Peter’s 2026/27 arts/PPE-type course fee **£41,390** ≈ HK\$440,000 **you pay**, plus £8,806 housing (37 weeks). Pembroke published total **£56,692** (tuition 47,648 + accommodation 7,666 + meal plan 1,378). vs Chicago exchange: T&N pays HK\$44,500 and Chicago bills you zero tuition. **False bargain unless HSBC Global (published enrichment cash up to HK\$300k) or equivalent lands — stacking UNVERIFIED.** Visiting also **burns the IAO visiting clause** for later HKUWW. Subject list has **no public health**. If you want Oxford at a defensible price, Recognized Programmes lists Exeter College Summer and LMH Summer — fee-paying, short, slot-free.

Why UBC is on this board even though you did not name it. Three documented reasons: (1) real undergraduate population-health courses, including environmental health and ageing — heat-health adjacency; (2) GHD has already walked the credit-transfer path; (3) 30 spots / Medicine earmark, widest gate in the PH-adjacent set. Honest cost: zero

T&N-China narrative. Those jobs belong to LINK, China Vision, WZQ, T&N's own Mainland rule, and the capstone — not to HKUWW, unless you choose Stack B.

12. Quantified comparison (named set)

Figures are **illustrative wedges** using 2025-26 / 2026-27 published stickers and 18–19 Aug 2026 FX. OOP is order-of-magnitude from host incoming pages, not a budget you should wire. HKU local subtractand = **HK\$44,500** unless noted.

HOST	DURATION	OCT 2025 SPOTS	TUITION WEDGE (HK\$)	OOP LIVING+FEES (HK\$, ORDER OF MAG.)	T&N 80K+40K VS OOP	RIGOR → 3.50
Chicago FY	3 quarters	4 FY	~515,000	193,000–275,000	Does not cover	GPA-exempt; capstone collision
Columbia S	1 semester	6 S	~264,000	95,000–125,000	Partial	GPA-exempt; IELTS 7.5
LSE FY	1 year	5 FY	~263,000–379,000	~202,000 + IHS	Partial	GPA-exempt; Health Policy dept likely closed; capstone collision
UTokyo FY	1 year	3 FY	~0 (sticker < HKU)	~60,000–120,000 (proof ¥1.44M ≈ 71k)	Likely covers a large share	GPA-exempt; capstone collision; English catalogue thin
Kyoto FY	1 year	1 FY	~0	similar Japan; KUINEP intro-level		English-thin
Waseda FY	1 year	2 FY	Small (private; school-dependent)	Japan-private housing; JASSO N/A 2026		Easier English if SILS
Osaka FY	1 year	5 FY	~0	NHI + ~¥80k/mo living colour		Med restrictions may apply
PKU S	1 semester	20 S	Small / negative	Lower than US (ISD living colour RMB 35k housing + 15k food + 5k misc per half-year ≈ HK\$32k+)	Likely covers	HSC blocked
Fudan S	1 semester	10 S	Small / negative	Dorm/canteen baseline ~HK\$24k–26k	Likely covers	Med blocked; SPH access unverified
Oxford visiting FY	1 year	n/a (not HKUWW)	Negative (you pay £41k–54k)	College housing extra	80k is a rounding error	Burns visiting clause; fee-paying

T&N 80k shared-cap arithmetic (Sol model, order of magnitude)

SCENARIO	OOP MODELED	AFTER 80K CAP	RESIDUAL GAP (BEFORE ASKING WHETHER 40K LIVING IS USABLE ABROAD)
Chicago FY	~193k–275k	0 left	~113k–195k
LSE FY	~202k + IHS	0 left	~122k+
Tokyo FY	≥71k	small remainder	NHI may eat it
PKU semester	≥32k	remainder	Insurance unpriced
Fudan dorm baseline	~24k–26k	~54k–56k left	
Chicago FY + PKU semester (if you could do both — you cannot on HKUWW)	—	—	Shows why the 80k is one pot

Read the Chicago row again: half a million HKD of tuition not paid is the correct intuition. The living row is why it is not “free undergraduate education.” It is a **heavily subsidised** year of a ~USD 98k COA product.

Sensitivity: 27/28 list drops Chicago; housing lottery fails; USHIP not waived; GBP/USD moves 10%; HKU local fee steps up toward the 47,000 new-intake line. None of those reverse the *sign* of the Chicago/LSE wedge. They do change whether the year is payable.

13. Rigor, letters, and what GHD actually needs

GHD is hosted by **SPH / LKS Medicine**, taught with Social Sciences, Business, Law, Science, Architecture.

What actually compounds for *your* thesis (CHP, China CDC, HK as seam, heat-health Laidlaw):

- Methods that travel: epi, health economics, policy evaluation, institutions.
- Letters from people who saw you do hard work (host transcript may never show on HKU GPA — letters matter more).
- Mandarin professional register.
- **Not missing GHAD3001 / the capstone.**

Chicago College + social science can mint the letter. It can also be the wrong building and the wrong calendar. LSE is development/econometrics, not Health Policy department. PKU/Fudan is T&N-native and may not include SPH (PKU HSC blocked; Fudan SPH **unverified**). **UBC is the path your programme has already walked**, with named undergrad population-health courses — boring, therefore informative.

Do not use exchange to skip the capstone. The capstone is the job-like semester. Exchange is school. A full-year Y3 that forces the capstone to slide is the largest unforced error on the board — unless SPH writes that GHAD3001 can move.

Tsinghua’s D/P/F exchange transcript is a special case: even letters struggle if the paper says Pass.

14. False bargains

1. **Oxford/Cambridge/Yale as HKUWW peers.** Worldwide Plus is fee-paying visiting. Live IAO page: **Oxford only.** Yale Y-VISP **closed**. Cambridge not listed. You pay £41k–57k; HKU scholarship HK\$100k; HSBC Global up to HK\$300k is contingent and **2026/27-cited, not 2027/28**. Visiting burns the slot.
2. **“Waived tuition = cash.”** Chicago’s ~HK\$515k wedge cannot pay the ~HK\$220k living bill.
3. **Columbia as a year.** It is not. Same token, ~half the wedge, four months.
4. **Japan as a money steal.** Todai/Kyoto/Osaka stickers are *below* HKU local. You go for the university and the country.
5. **PKU as SPH / China CDC training.** HSC is blocked. CDC is a capstone question.
6. **PKU/Waseda as AFLSP.** HKU is not a BXAI partner. Wrong instrument, wrong degree stage, sometimes wrong direction of travel.
7. **AFPLA as a programme you “join by exchanging.”** It is a club with a CV and an interview.
8. **Spending the slot on Mainland because T&N requires Mainland.** T&N duration is flexible and already promotes short programmes. Mainland access is repeatable through LINK, China Vision, MES, WZQ, T&N camps. HKUWW is the only instrument that buys a subsidised semester at a *non-Chinese* institution. Stack B can still be right — but not because it is the only way to satisfy T&N.
9. **UCEAP “70 spots” as a Berkeley ticket.** Campus lottery; leftover round already showed 18.
10. **Endeavour Fund as exchange living.** GBA/career/start-up wording. Do not budget it for Hyde Park rent.

15. Application pack

Tests

- IAO floor: IELTS 6.5 / TOEFL 93.
- Chicago: IELTS 7.0 **all subs** or TOEFL 104 (26 each).
- Columbia: IELTS 7.5 or TOEFL 105.
- LSE: School's standard English; check GO LSE page the year you apply.
- UTokyo Type U: 90/6.5 or English-medium exemption letter.

Book a test whose validity covers **April 2027** host deadlines (Chicago/Columbia fact sheets; UTokyo Type U autumn application end-Feb). IB English A 7 is useful for IAO upload; do not assume it satisfies Chicago/Columbia.

100-word PS (drafts — edit, do not inflate)

Must contain: why exchange; why first-choice institution; why first-choice country; **if FY, why a year**. Count words.

Stack A • Chicago (cut to 100):

I am applying for a full-year exchange because I study global health as methods and institutions, not as a semester of sightseeing. Chicago's College is a three-quarter curriculum; a single term would mutilate the year. I want argument-heavy undergraduate work plus access to political economy and, if registration allows, public-policy electives — tools for heat, ageing, and cross-border disease control. The United States is the country because it still trains the evaluation style that international agencies read. I will return to a GHD capstone aimed at China CDC; the year is for rigor, not exit.

Stack A • LSE:

LSE does not offer a single-semester exchange. I need the year because GO LSE assessment is year-long units, issued once, in May. I study global health and development; International Social and Public Policy and related development units are the closest English-language match on HKUWW to the work I already do (Laidlaw heat-health, CHP/seam thesis). London is the country-city because health-policy institutions sit there, and I will already have been in London for the Laidlaw conference. A semester would be a different, lesser programme.

Stack B • PKU:

I am applying to Peking University to spend a semester inside a Chinese research university as a Mandarin-capable Global Health and Development student. The point is institutional fluency — how a leading Mainland university teaches state, society, and policy — not a clinical rotation (I know HSC/medicine is closed to standard exchange). China is the first-choice country because my scholarship and my degree both require competence in the Mainland system; Beijing is where that competence is densest. I will take Chinese-taught social science where allowed and keep the GHD capstone for China CDC.

Worked Chicago OOP (order of magnitude, not a wire)

Using 2025-26 College COA housing/food USD 20,835 + services 1,623 + U-Pass 318 + books 1,800 + personal 1,950 + USHIP ~4,998 if not waived ≈ **USD 31,500 ≈ HK\$247,000** at 7.8439. Subtract T&N living HK\$40,000 and assume the entire HK\$80,000 exchange cap is spent on this year (zero left for Mainland travel) → **still ~HK\$127,000 uncovered** before flights. If you split the 80k with a Mainland summer, uncovered is higher. This is the sentence to sit with before calling the year “free.”

Preference-list templates (do not blend)

Stack A (overseas year) — example order, not a command:

1. Chicago (FY)

2. LSE (FY)
3. UTokyo (FY)
4. Waseda (FY)
5. Osaka (FY)
6. Durham (FY)
7. UBC (S) — GHD-walked path; PH courses that actually exist
8. Columbia (S) — only if you accept burning the slot on four months
9. McGill / Edinburgh / KCL / NTU as depth

Do **not** put Columbia above a FY school if you mean duration.

Stack B (Mainland semester):

1. PKU **or** Fudan (Fudan first *only after* SPH-access email)
2. The other of PKU/Fudan
3. ZJU / NJU
4. SJTU
5. Tsinghua (lottery; D/P/F transcript)
6. RUC

Faculty conversation (this week, not in December)

- Confirm which **faculty code** GHD uses on HKUWW (Medicine vs Social Sciences).
- Confirm credit-transfer for College / LSE units vs GHD major vs electives, and whether a “50% of major at HKU” rule exists for GHD.
- Confirm whether LINK or China Vision summer is treated as a “semester exchange” (it should not be — get it in writing from IAO).
- Confirm SPH **GHAD3001** / **GHAD4010** semester, codes, and whether a Y3 full year is even legal for the capstone chain.
- Confirm whether “overseas” capstone admits mainland China / China CDC.

Foundation conversation

One email: “Does LINK (3-week Shanghai) or a China Vision PKU/Fudan summer satisfy the compulsory Mainland exchange if I use HKUWW 2027/28 on a full-year international partner?”

Until the answer is written, Stack A is a **conditional**.

Host emails worth sending

- Fudan incoming@fudan.edu.cn — SPH undergrad access for inbound exchange.
- PKU ISD / IAO — HSC block vs SPH; which inbound channel HKUWW uses.
- UTokyo AFPLA chapter — can Type U students sit spring recruiting.
- UNC Gillings — BSPH courses for exchange.
- Columbia UGE — English-test exemption; CC PUBH seats for incoming exchange.

16. What you wanted to hear, and the counter

You are right that **UChicago at HKU local tuition is a steal** for a full undergraduate year at a US private *if the Oct-shaped list still contains it in 2027/28*. The 2025-26 sticker is USD 71,325; you would not pay it. Four FY spots, *******, three quarters, College catalogue, Core optional. Host grades will not dent T&N 3.50. That sentence can stay.

The counters, because compounding is not flattery:

- Living is a second tuition (~HK\$0.19–0.28M OOP).
- Four spots is a knife fight; March leftovers already showed Chicago gone.
- Core/Harris-adjacent is not Mailman. There is no undergraduate Mailman/LSHTM year anywhere.
- Columbia is not a year. CC PUBH bulletin courses are the honest PH path there.
- LSE is another steal, closer to development methods, **not** a Health Policy department year.
- Todai is a year without a tuition steal; AFPLA is a club; AFLSP is a different, closed door; NIID is now JIHS.
- PKU will not quietly enrol you in SPH.
- Oxford visiting is how people pay £45k–57k to feel like they went to Oxford.
- **A Y3 full year can spend the China CDC capstone window.** Ask SPH before you fall in love with duration.
- Exchange does not raise your GPA. A year thins the graded record that MPhil/JD readers actually use.

17. Open questions that reorder the board

Falsifiers, so this primer can be killed by evidence.

#	IF THIS IS TRUE	WHAT CHANGES
1	SPH confirms 6HAD3001 can move to Y2 or Y4, or capstone can start Y4 summer without delaying graduation	Reopens Stack A as a full year without buying the CDC window
2	SPH confirms no 50%-at-HKU major rule and will transfer host PH units into the major	Strengthens any host with real PH teaching
3	2027/28 partner PDF drops Chicago/Columbia/LSE or adds a UK SPH	Rebuild the named set
4	Fudan confirms SPH courses for inbound HKUWW	Fudan can outrank PKU on Stack B <i>coursework</i>
5	PKU confirms the medicine block does <i>not</i> reach PUHSC SPH	Restores PKU as dual-purpose
6	IAO confirms LINK/China Vision do consume HKUWW eligibility	Inverts the one-slot argument
7	Foundation confirms LINK or a 4-week summer does satisfy compulsory Mainland	Stack A is no longer conditional on T&N
8	Capstone “overseas” admits China CDC	Raises the cost of disrupting Y3 further
9	Type U English catalogue for 2027/28 is thick in health systems	Todai moves up on coursework
10	AFPLA chapters admit inbound exchange	Network upside becomes real, still not a reason to pick the host alone
11	BXAI counts HK as a distinct region and a partner master’s is realistic	AFLSP becomes a postgraduate target
12	T&N reads host grades despite HKU GPA exclusion	Restores “rigor risk” as a scholarship issue

Deadline that governs the first two: main round opens 12 Oct 2026. Questions 1, 2, 6, 7 should be answered before you write the 100 words.

18. Method

Operator-plane research, 19 Aug 2026.

- Parsed IAO PDFs: 9 Oct 2025 full list and 11 Mar 2026 leftover list. Structured extract: `.tmp/hkuww-primer/premier-partners.json` and `claims.jsonl`.
- Crawled IAO programme pages and host incoming-exchange / bursar / fact sheets for the named set and peers.
- Subagents: **Sol** (value, OOP, T&N cap, calendars, false bargains); **Fable** (course access, housing, AFPLA); **Opus** (adversarial GHD-tool review — keep GPA/capstone/LSE-Health-Policy/UBC/PKU-HSC/AFLSP; **discard leftover-list “Chicago N/A”**); Japan / Mainland / Anglosphere crawls.
- Community/student-club pages used only as texture and labelled.
- No invented fees, quotas, or admit rates. 27/28 partner PDF, if posted during a later cycle, **replaces** 26/27 quotas.

Companion review: `docs/exchange-review-ghd-hkuww.md`. Capture: `content/captures/2026-08-19-hkuww-premier-exchange.yaml`.

19. Sources (accessed 2026-08-19 unless noted)

- HKUWW rules & 2027/28 timeline: <https://intlaffairs.hku.hk/hku-worldwide-student-exchange>
- Institution list 9 Oct 2025: https://intlaffairs.hku.hk/backend/wp-content/uploads/2025/10/HKUWW2627_Institution_list_20251009.pdf
- Leftover list 11 Mar 2026: https://intlaffairs.hku.hk/backend/wp-content/uploads/2026/03/HKUWW2627_20260311.pdf
- Prepare to study abroad / credit transfer: <https://intlaffairs.hku.hk/academic>
- Senate CAT policy: https://cdqa.hku.hk/doc/Credit_Accumulation_and_Transfer_Policy.pdf
- Horizons taxonomy: <https://tl.hku.hk/horizons/overview/>
- T&N benefits: <https://tungngaifoundation.org/financial-awards-benefits/>
- T&N 2025 annual report (short Mainland options): Foundation PDF
- HKU composition fee 2025-26 / 2026-27 handbooks
- GHD exchange: <https://ghd.sph.hku.hk/international-exchange>
- GHD capstone: SPH capstone page; BASc(GHD) regulations PDF
- UChicago IAO, ISAL academics/coming-to, historical COA, bursar College 2025-26, HKU-hosted 2025-26 fact sheet
- Columbia IAO, UGE incoming exchange, CC-SEAS 2026-27 COA, CC public-health bulletin
- LSE GO HKU country page; Table of Fees 2026/27; GO LSE Offer Pack 2026-27; GC programme regulations 2025/26; term dates
- UTokyo tuition; USTEP Type U; Type U fact sheet; AFPLA UT about page
- Kyoto KUINEP; Waseda CIE/SILS fact sheet 2026; Osaka 2026-27 fact sheet
- Worldwide Plus Visiting (Oxford fees); Yale Y-VISP closure page
- China Vision PKU/Fudan summer programme pages; LINK about page
- PKU ISD exchange page / HKU-hosted PKU & Fudan fact sheets (medicine/HSC restrictions)
- UBC Go Global restrictions; UBC SPPH calendar
- BXAI AFLSP overview / exchange scholarship
- JIHS (NIID merger 1 Apr 2025)
- ECB eurofxref 19 Aug 2026 (Sol FX cross-check)

Reverify: 2027/28 partner PDF when IAO posts it (likely Oct 2026); host fact sheets after nomination; T&N Mainland definition; GHD faculty code; IELTS slots; GHAD course codes; Fudan SPH; AFPLA inbound rules; capstone geography.

Machine-readable claims: `.tmp/hkuww-primer/claims.jsonl` (52 rows: `sourceId`, `accessed date`, `confidence`, `reverifyAfter`). Reprint the register when the 27/28 partner PDF drops rather than editing numbers in prose first.

Operator primer. Not publication. Not advice to decline T&N. Not a promise of nomination. Two stacks are equals.

20. Claims register (volatile)

Machine copy: `.tmp/hkuww-primer/claims.jsonl`. Re-check anything past `reverifyAfter` before you submit. Quotas die when the 2027/28 partner PDF posts.

ID	CLAIM	CONF.	REVERIFY
c-cycle	HKUWW 2027/28 main round: apply 12 Oct–11 Dec 2026; results 5 Feb 2027; accept + HK\$2,000 by 12 Feb 2027. Year 2+ placement priority.	high	2026-10-12
c-one-slot	Eligibility requires not having joined any previous semester exchange or special visiting programme organised by IAO, faculties or departments.	high	2026-10-12
c-english-iao	IAO English floor IELTS 6.5 or TOEFL 93; hosts may be higher.	high	2026-10-12
c-oct-chicago	Oct 2025 list: Chicago EXTU10960 4 full-year spots, ***, full year only.	high	2026-10-12
c-oct-columbia	Oct 2025 list: Columbia EXTU10662 6 semester spots, ***.	high	2026-10-12
c-oct-lse	Oct 2025 list: LSE EXTU11459 5 full-year spots, ***, FY only, ≥2 years of study.	high	2026-10-12
c-oct-todai	Oct 2025 list: UTokyo EXTU10925 3 FY, ***, CGPA 3.3, ≥2 years, FY only.	high	2026-10-12
c-oct-kyoto	Oct 2025 list: Kyoto EXTU10362 1 FY, ***, CGPA 3.3, FY only.	high	2026-10-12
c-oct-waseda	Oct 2025 list: Waseda EXTU11506 2 FY, **, CGPA 3.3, FY only.	high	2026-10-12
c-oct-osaka	Oct 2025 list: Osaka EXTU10241 5 FY, ***, CGPA 3.3, ≥2 years, FY only.	high	2026-10-12
c-oct-pku	Oct 2025 list: PKU EXTU10090 20 semester, ***, Medicine 3 earmarked; medicine programmes or courses not available.	high	2026-10-12
c-oct-fudan	Oct 2025 list: Fudan EXTU10425 10 semester, ***, no restriction note on PDF line.	high	2026-10-12
c-oct-tsinghua	Oct 2025 list: Tsinghua EXTU10933 2 semester, ***.	high	2026-10-12
c-oct-uceap	Oct 2025 list: UC via UCEAP 70 semester spots, campus lottery among Berkeley Davis Irvine UCLA UCSD UCSB UCSC.	high	2026-10-12
c-oct-ubc	Oct 2025 list: UBC EXTU10955 30 semester, ***, Medicine earmark 3, non-law only for Law column.	high	2026-10-12
c-oct-ucl	Oct 2025 list: UCL EXTU10946 6 semester, *** ; courses only in Anthro, Arts & Sci, Econ, Geography, History of Art.	high	2026-10-12
c-mar-leftover	11 Mar 2026 PDF is leftover/late-round inventory, not a cancellation of Chicago/Columbia/Waseda.	high	2026-10-12

ID	CLAIM	CONF.	REVERIFY
c-gpa-exempt	Transferred host results are not included in HKU GPA and typically do not appear on the transcript.	high	2027-06-01
c-credit-caps	Semester of full-time host study normally up to 30 HKU credits (max 36); year up to 60 (max 72); 120 transferred-credit ceiling.	high	2027-06-01
c-ghad4010	BASc(GHD) regulations: GHAD4010 capstone normally Y3 Summer through end Y4 S1; prerequisite includes GHAD3001 (Y3).	high	2026-10-01
c-ghad-y3-electives	GHD Year 3 is 66 credits with 48 elective.	high	2026-10-01
c-tn-benefits	T&N: full HKU tuition, HK\$40k living/year, up to HK\$80k shared for compulsory Mainland + optional international, duration flexible; Endeavour up to HK\$100k GBA/career.	high	2026-10-12
c-tn-gpa	T&N renewal GPA ≥ 3.50 (AASO scheme text).	high	2026-10-12
c-hku-fee-2526	HKU local composition fee 2025-26 handbook HK\$44,500.	medium	2026-09-15
c-hku-fee-2627	HKU 2026-27 new-intake local composition fee HK\$47,000; non-local STEM (Medicine) HK\$249,000.	high	2026-10-12
c-chicago-tuition	UChicago College tuition 2025-26 USD 71,325.	high	2026-12-01
c-chicago-english	Chicago ISAL English: TOEFL 104 (26 each) or IELTS 7 (7 each) or Duolingo 135.	high	2027-02-12
c-chicago-isal	ISALs: full College catalogue access; no academic requirements to UChicago; 3–4 courses/quarter; major enrolment not guaranteed; off-campus Hyde Park.	high	2027-02-12
c-columbia-english	Columbia incoming exchange: TOEFL 105 / IELTS 7.5 / Duolingo 135; CC/SEAS; pay room/board/fees/insurance to Columbia.	high	2027-02-12
c-columbia-tuition	Columbia College 2026-27 tuition USD 72,800; continuing on-campus COA USD 100,884.	high	2026-12-01
c-lse-go	GO LSE reciprocal exchange (not fee-paying General Course); no single-semester; CGPA 3.3; two years by arrival.	high	2027-02-12
c-lse-health-policy	2025/26 General Course open departments do not include Department of Health Policy or International Development.	high	2026-09-15
c-lse-living	GO LSE Offer Pack 2026-27: 39-week living guide £19,030; IHS £776; halls guaranteed if booked by published deadline.	high	2027-02-12
c-todai-tuition	UTokyo UG tuition ¥642,960/year for 2025+ entrants; exchange students exempt from host tuition.	high	2027-02-12
c-todai-typeu	USTEP Type U: Senior Division; 300+ English courses/year; no practical/lab work; TOEFL 90/IELTS 6.5 or English-medium exemption; proof ¥120,000/month.	high	2027-02-12
c-afpla	AFPLA members: UTokyo, PKU, Fudan, SNU, NTU. Student forum + summer gathering. Inbound exchange eligibility unpublished.	high	2027-03-01
c-aflsp	AFLSP/BXAI partners do not include HKU (HK partners CUHK, HKUST). Exchange scholarship is for Japanese students outbound to BXAI partners.	high	2027-01-01
c-wwplus-oxford	Worldwide Plus Visiting: Oxford St Peter's/Pembroke; pay host fees; CGPA ≥ 3.7 ; scholarship up to HK\$100,000. St Peter's 2026/27 course fees £41,390–£54,380 + £8,806 accommodation.	high	2026-10-12
c-yale-closed	Yale Y-VISP visiting programme is closed.	high	2026-10-12
c-pku-hsc	Partner fact sheets: PKU Health Science Center not available to ordinary exchange students.	high	2027-02-12

ID	CLAIM	CONF.	REVERIFY
c-link	LINK is a 12-credit HKU course with 3-week Shanghai or HCMC immersion; HK\$5,000 subsidy; Teaching & Learning, not IAO HKUWW.	high	2026-11-01
c-horizons	Horizons taxonomy separates Exchange/Visiting (HKUWW) from Short-term Study/Study Trip (China Vision).	high	2026-10-12
c-ubc-spph	UBC SPPH undergrad courses include SPPH 200/301, 300, 303, 304, 406; SPHA closed to exchange; limited SPPH seats.	high	2027-02-12
c-ghd-ubc-example	GHD international-exchange page names UBC as first-cohort destination.	high	2026-10-12
c-jihhs	NIID and NCGM merged into JIHS on 1 April 2025.	high	2027-04-01
c-tn-mainland-uncertain	Foundation publishes duration flexibility and promotes short Mainland programmes; does not explicitly state that LINK or China Vision summer satisfies compulsory Mainland exchange.	medium	2026-09-30
c-fudan-sph-unverified	Fudan SPH access for inbound HKUWW exchange students is unverified.	low	2026-09-30
c-fx	FX used ~18–19 Aug 2026: USD/HKD 7.8439; GBP/HKD 10.63; JPY/HKD 0.0493. ECB cross-check USD/HKD 7.8416.	medium	2027-02-12
c-nw-s2	Oct 2025 list: Northwestern EXTU11386 4 spots, ***, Semester 2 only.	high	2026-10-12
c-waseda-jasso	Waseda AY2026 fact sheet: JASSO scholarships not available. COE proof ¥120,000/month.	high	2027-02-12
c-ghd-faculty-unverified	Whether GHD applies under Medicine or Social Sciences faculty code on HKUWW is unverified.	low	2026-09-30
c-capstone-cdc-unverified	Whether GHD capstone 'overseas' admits mainland China / China CDC as host is unverified.	low	2026-09-30